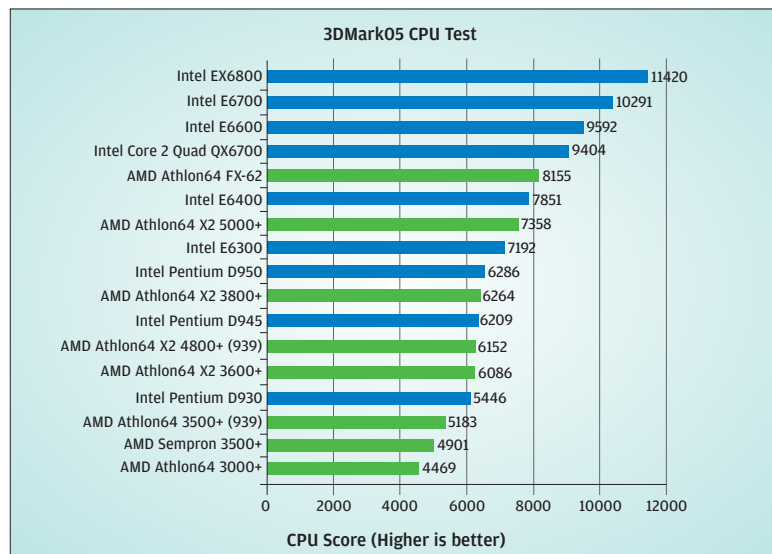
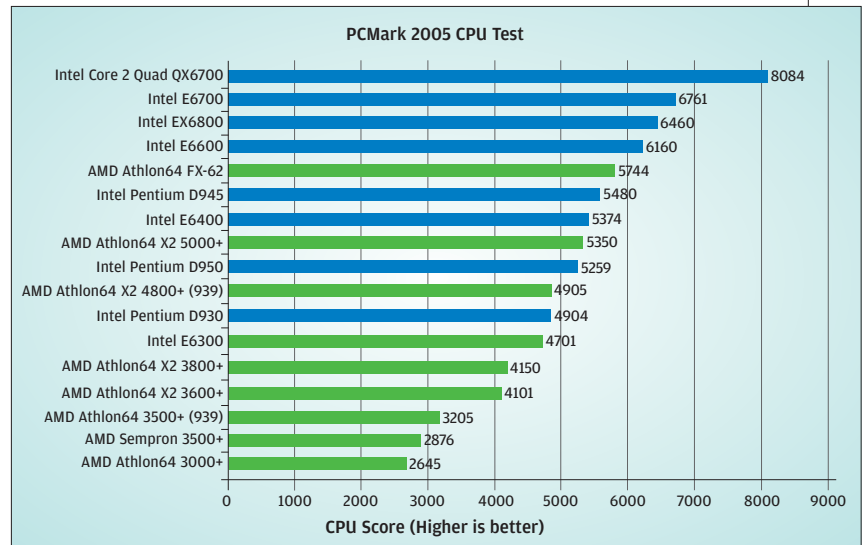


Gaming and Multimedia

PCMark05

The latest Quad Core QX6700 from Intel makes an impact by delivering unbelievable scores. In this test, it outperforms the Core 2 EX6800 by a delightful 25 per cent and the AMD FX-62 by 40 per cent—superb! Except for the lower-end Core 2 E6300, all other Intel Core 2 processors were ahead of their respective AMD counterparts. The AMD FX-62 was the only processor that could compare with the new Intel processors. The older Pentium D processors can hardly match the performance of the new Intel Core 2 Duos—it's about time to bid them adieu. What's interesting to note is the performance gap between the best performer and the worst is around 300 per cent; we have never come across such figures.



3DMark05

Here the Core 2 EX6800 takes the mantle by posting a brilliant score of 11K, which is nearly 40 per cent better than the AMD FX-62. The E6700 which retails for nearly half of the EX6800; delivers just 10 per cent less, making it an excellent performer for the price. Interestingly, the QX6700 (Quad Core) is behind both the Core 2 Duo processors, though this is more a limitation of the benchmark than the processor itself. Writing applications for the Quad Core will require proper optimisation if we are to see it delivering the best performance possible. Apart from the FX-62 and the 5000+, none of the AMD processors deliver respectable performance. The Core-based processors completely outshone the older Pentium Ds.

3DMark 06

3DMark06 is a relatively new benchmark and hence makes the most out of newer hardware—this is evident from the scores we see. The QX6700 came out tops, posting the best score—nearly 72 per cent higher than the EX6800 and 84 per cent over the AMD FX-62. The rest of the graph is nearly identical to the ones we have seen before. The AMD AM2 processors hardly match the Core 2 Duo and the older Pentium D series is completely overshadowed by its successor.

